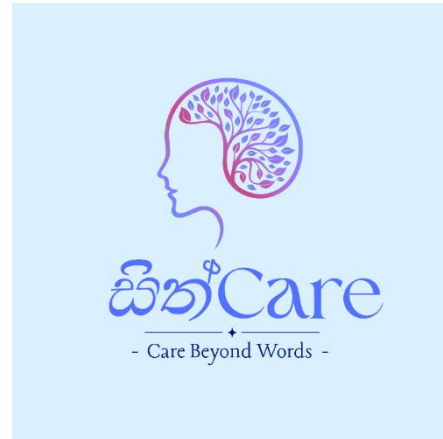




# **SENG 31242 – System Design Project**

## **Persona 03**

## **Interview Transcript**

### **SithCare Channelling App**

### **Group 10**



## Interview Transcript of Mental Health Patients – SithCare Channeling App

**Date of Interview:** 23/05/2026 (Saturday)

**Location:** Conducted remotely via Zoom

**Interviewer:** Project Member, SithCare Chanelling App

**Interviewee:** Persona 3, a 24-year-old, employed as a nursing assistant at a private nursing home.

**Interview Objective:** To explore mental health patients' experiences and requirements for improved digital support.

**Consent:** The interviewee has consented to the interview being recorded and transcribed for internal documentation.

**Source Link:** [Persona 03 Interview](#)

### Opening Statement

“Thank you for participating. We are developing a mental health support application to improve accessibility and support for patients. Your responses are confidential and will only be used for academic purposes. You may skip any question or stop at any point if uncomfortable. There are no right or wrong answers; we simply want to understand your experience.”

### Section 1: Background Information (Ice Breaker)

**Q1. Could you tell us a little about yourself? (Age range, occupation/student status, and anything you'd like to share about your lifestyle.)**

**Purpose:** *Understand demographics and routines.*

**Answer:** I am 24 years old and currently working as a nursing assistant in a private nursing home. I do home nursing, so I usually stay at my patient's house and rarely go home. Most of my daily life revolves around patient care. During my free time, I enjoy reading and listening to music.

**Q2. Are you comfortable sharing your mental health diagnosis or concerns?**

(Follow-up)

- When were you diagnosed?
- How did you realise something was wrong?



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- Who diagnosed you?

**Purpose:** Understand conditions.

**Answer:** I was diagnosed when I was around 14 years old, in 2018. At that time, I started feeling very suicidal, lost my appetite, and stopped socializing with children at school. My teachers noticed that I was sleeping excessively. I told my parents that I was not feeling well that I was suicidal, and that I wanted to see a doctor. In 2018, I visited a psychiatrist at a private hospital, and I was diagnosed with clinical depression with psychotic symptoms.

### **Q3. What symptoms or struggles do you experience because of your condition?**

**Answer:** My biggest struggle has been managing daily activities. I would get overwhelmed even with basic hygiene tasks. I remember times when I could not brush my teeth or get out of bed. It felt like I was paralyzed. Keeping up with everyday routines was extremely difficult. I also experienced hallucinations at one point, which frightened me and motivated me to seek medical help.

## **Section 2: Current Mental Healthcare Experience**

### **Q4. Can you describe your experience seeking mental health support?**

**Answer:** Seeking help was not difficult because of cost, since there were good psychiatrists available where I lived in Kandy. However, the most challenging part was emotionally opening up to my parents and telling them I was struggling mentally.

### **Q5. What challenges do you face when booking appointments? (based on personal experience)**

**Answer:** One challenge is that appointments with psychiatrists often feel too short, and there is not enough time during sessions. Traveling to appointments was also difficult because I had to visit every two weeks. Sometimes, I had to cancel my plans just to attend appointments.

### **Q6. Have you ever delayed seeking help? Why?**

**Answer:** Yes. After taking medication for around three months, I thought I was getting better and believed I could handle things on my own. I also disliked taking medication, so I delayed appointments. Eventually, I relapsed and had to return for treatment with my parents. This happened around three to four times.



### **Q7. How comfortable are you discussing mental health openly?**

**Answer:** I am comfortable discussing mental health with my family and friends. However, I avoid talking about it with my coworkers because I feel they may see me as different or strange, so I keep it to myself in workplace environments.

## **Section 03: Technology Usage & Digital Behavior**

### **Q8. Do you currently use any apps/websites related to mental health?**

(Follow Up) What do you like/dislike about them?

**Answer:** No, I do not currently use any mental health apps or websites. However, I think it would be very helpful if I could attend therapy sessions online through my phone instead of travelling to a therapist physically.

Previously, I booked appointments by calling private hospital reception counters directly.

### **Q9. What frustrates you about existing healthcare or appointment systems? (Any improvements?)**

**Answer:** I would prefer to meet a medical professional for several sessions before receiving a diagnosis. Based on my experience, some medical professionals diagnose patients after only a few minutes.

I also think appointment booking through websites or apps would be much easier than calling hospitals. I would like to see doctors listed with details such as their experience, qualifications, and gender so I can choose someone I feel comfortable with.

### **Q10. If a mental health app existed, what would make you trust it?**

**Answer:** Privacy would matter most to me. I would not want my personal information to be shared. I would also trust an app more if it included verified doctor profiles and professional credentials.

## **Section 4: Therapist Matching (Aimed at therapist rec. Qs.)**

### **Q11. When looking for a therapist, what information matters most?**



## **Interview Transcript of Mental Health Patients – SithCare Channeling App**

**Answer:** Language matters most to me because I previously had a therapist who spoke Tamil, and communication became difficult when expressing myself naturally. I would also like to know their experience in the field, gender, because I feel safer with female therapists, and qualifications and professional background.

### **Q12. What questions should an app ask before recommending a therapist?**

I think the app should ask about: My symptoms, how long I have experienced those symptoms, My gender preference for therapists, Previous diagnoses, and Session preferences. Knowing my symptoms is important because it would help the app recommend a more suitable therapist.

## **Section 5: Emergency & Crisis Situations**

### **Q13. Have you experienced a mental health crisis? Only if comfortable**

**Answer:** Yes. I have experienced panic attacks, severe depression, emotional breakdowns, and suicidal depression. I received treatment for panic attacks during school and underwent treatment for depression for around three years. I have attempted suicide approximately three times.

### **Q14. During emergencies, what support would help you most?**

**Answer:** Rather than emergency medical support, I would prefer someone close to me during a breakdown. I would appreciate an app that could automatically send my live location to trusted friends or family members so they could come and support me.

### **Q15. Would you use emergency same-day booking? Why?**

**Answer:** Yes, absolutely. From my experience, when I decide to seek help, I need access immediately. If I delay, I may become overwhelmed by my illness and think about harming myself. Therefore, same-day appointments would be extremely valuable.

## **Section 6: Anonymous Community & Peer Support**

### **Q16. Would anonymous support groups help you? Why?**

**Answer:** Yes. I often feel more comfortable sharing my problems with people I do not know rather than with people close to me. Because of that, anonymous support groups would be helpful.



### **Q17. What concerns would you have about anonymous communities?**

**Answer:** My biggest concern would be privacy. I would not want my struggles to spread through social media or become public. Privacy would be my main concern.

## **Section 7: Privacy & Security (As mental health data is sensitive)**

### **Q18. What privacy concerns would stop you from using a mental health app?**

**Answer:** I would not use an app if my information were shared with family members or third parties without my permission. I believe apps should always ask for my consent before using or sharing my data, even if it is intended for positive purposes.

### **Q19. Would anonymity encourage you to seek support earlier?**

**Answer:** Yes, definitely. Seeking support using my real identity feels exposing. I worry that people may judge me or that my information could be shared. Remaining anonymous would make me more likely to seek support earlier.

## **Final Question (Ending)**

### **Q20. Is there anything you wish healthcare providers or technology developers understood better about mental health patients?**

**Answer:** I want healthcare professionals to understand that seeking help does not mean a person is already better. Even while attending therapy or psychiatric appointments, someone may still be struggling with thoughts of self-harm or suicide. I want them to understand that people seek treatment because they are trying to get better, not because they have already recovered.

## **Closing Statement**

“Thank you for sharing your experiences. Your insights will help us design a more accessible and supportive mental health application for people who may face similar challenges.”